

How to Play

Printable leaflet - two pages. Print this file directly (browser print or any Markdown-to-PDF tool), or read it on screen. Replaces the old `leaflet-how-to-play-A4-portrait.svg` / `leaflet-how-to-play-2-A4-portrait.svg` pair - same wording, plain text instead of hand-laid SVG.

Seven weeks. Thirty-five days. One project standing between your team and the deadline - your team commits five days at a time, resolves them all at once, then closes the week and moves on. From week 2, Events crash into the week you already committed to - spend Adaptability to re-plan around them or cancel them outright. Deliver every Feature before Week 7 closes to win the project - but hit a Team Score of 80+ and you didn't just finish it, you built a team that could survive doing it again: Sustainable High Performance.

Page 1 of 2 · Setup and Week 1

Setting up

About fifteen minutes, and the first part is the best part.

1. Deal each player five habitus parts at random and **assemble the figure** onto the Specimen board.

1. Take the matching **NEED** tile (your VALUES) and **HERO** tile (your PRESSURE RESPONSE), and slot those too.

1. Turn over board **THE ZONE**. Place your figure's tile on the grid: your Legs' row × your Item's column.

1. Read the row/column rule and what **Learn/Teach** do in one line each - no detail needed yet.

1. Pick one **PROJECT** card. Turn **THE PROJECT** face up and seat it - it names features A-F.

2. Read the project and its six features together - complexity, LOCK tiles across **D** and **F**, what unlocks what.

1. Go through the **Activity cards** that come out now: **Work, Coordinate, Celebrate**. The rest wait for later weeks.

Finish the room

- Only **THE PROJECT** and **THE ZONE** start face up. **SHIT HAPPENS** and **THE TEAM** stay text side up; **THE PAYOFF** and **STANDING** stay boxed.

- Motivation 3** for every character. Week marker on Week 1. Shuffle the Events but don't draw yet.

- *Everything on the covered boards already sits at 2. It just isn't your problem for a few more weeks.*

Week 1

Deliberately almost trivial - lay five cards, resolve them, close the week.

Only **THE PROJECT** and **THE ZONE** are face up. Shit Happens, Adapt and the Ledger wait for week 2; the Specimen panel on your person board isn't read until week 3.

1 · Plan the week

Lay **five Activity cards** across Monday to Friday. Put a character disc on each - that person's Skill, Knowledge and Capital apply to that day. One person may take several days, or none. A slot may instead take a **Flex marker**, giving back a day someone worked as Overtime. *Then stop. Nothing has resolved.*

2 · The week runs

Resolve all **five** cards. **Order does not matter** - the week happened at once, not one day at a time.

3 · Close the week

Bank any feature that finished (lift its lock, if any, and pay Capital). Everyone then **loses 1 Motivation** - the weekly grind. Nobody empties out on week 1 alone, so there is nothing else to check yet. *Move the week marker one step closer to the deadline. That's the whole week - three steps, no exceptions.*

bank before the grind - it's the only spend this week.

From week 2

THE TEAM turns face up: **the Ledger** - Trust, Capability, Shared Practice, Adaptability - starts being read at Close the Week. Nothing else about a week changes yet.

A week is five days, and you choose them. That's the entire idea, before anything else gets added to it.

Flip this sheet when Week 1 closes → Week 2 on is on the back

The same five days, but the table has more to say about them with every week that passes.

The pulse, from week 2 on

The same five steps, every week until week 7 closes.

- 1 · Plan the week

Lay **five Activity cards** across Monday to Friday, one character disc each. *Then stop. Nothing has resolved.*
- 2 · Shit happens

Draw **two Event cards, face up** - and **do not resolve them yet**. They are threats, aimed at the week you already committed. *A day spent on the wrong thing is simply lost.*
- 3 · Adapt

Spend **Adaptability**: each 1 replaces one card, or pays an Event's ADAPT number to cancel it outright.
- 4 · The week runs

Resolve whatever survived Adapt, then all five cards. **Order does not matter** - the week happened at once.
- 5 · Close the week

Bank completed features (lift any lock, pay Capital) → **walk the Ledger** coins, at most one step each, and flip any that reached its ring → **Motivation as one net number**: -1 for the grind - every week, +1 if the Need was met.
- bank first - it pays the capital the ledger needs.
apply motivation as one number, then check for zero.*

Week 2: the Ledger + Shit Happens/Adapt, together. **Week 3:** the Development + Specimen panel - Capital, Need, Overtime, Flex. **Week 4:** Standing.

How it ends

The project ends when Week 7 closes.

Team Score = (features × 10) + (4 tracks, max 20) + (Motivation) – (10 × quits) – (2 × unrepaid Flex)

Outcome	Condition	
Failure	Not everything delivered.	The score doesn't matter.
Heroic Success	All six banked, score under 80.	The project made it. The team didn't.
High Performance	All six banked, score 80+.	You built a team as well.

If you only had thirty-five working days, how would you spend them?